

REFLECTION FOR CORPUS CHRISTI (BODY AND BLOOD OF CHRIST)

22nd June 2025

Theme: “Jesus Is the Bread That Never Goes Stale”

Readings:

First Reading: Genesis 14:18–20

Psalm: Psalm 109(110):1–4

Second Reading: 1 Corinthians 11:23–26

Gospel: Luke 9:11–17

Introduction:

There’s a saying in Africa: “A person who has eaten does not argue.” Why? Because food calms the body, fills the stomach, and brings peace.

Today, we reflect on the greatest food of all time—not rice, not breadfruit, not even fried chicken—but the Body and Blood of Jesus Christ.

This feast of Corpus Christi reminds us that Jesus is not just “food for thought,” but food for the soul. Let’s explore how these readings reveal:

1. The priestly role of Christ
2. The reality of the Eucharist
3. Our call to share in this divine meal

1. Melchizedek and Jesus – The Eternal Priest (Genesis 14:18–20 & Psalm 110)

“Melchizedek, king of Salem, brought out bread and wine; he was priest of God Most High.” (Genesis 14:18)

Let's begin with this mysterious figure—Melchizedek, who suddenly appears, blesses Abram, offers bread and wine, and then disappears from the scene. The Psalm (110) later confirms:

“You are a priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek.” (Psalm 110:4)

Why is this important?

Because Jesus is not just any priest—He is the eternal High Priest. Melchizedek is a foreshadowing, a preview, of Jesus.

In offering bread and wine, Melchizedek points to what Jesus will one day do in the Last Supper and Holy Mass.

Church Teaching:

The Catechism of the Catholic Church (CCC 1544) says:

“The unique priesthood of Christ is made present through the ministerial priesthood of the Church.”

So, if Melchizedek was like a cook who came to serve a special meal, Jesus is the Master Chef, serving the Heavenly Banquet.

2. The Real Presence of Jesus (1 Corinthians 11:23–26)

“This is my body that is for you. Do this in remembrance of me.”

Here, St. Paul quotes Jesus' words at the Last Supper. And he doesn't say, “This represents my body” or “This symbolizes my blood.” No—Jesus says “This **IS** my body... this **IS** my blood.”

This is not just a symbol. It's real. Just like when a child gives you a drawing of their family—it's not the family itself, but a symbol. But the Eucharist? It's Jesus Himself.

Church Teaching:

CCC 1376 says: *“By the consecration of the bread and wine there takes place a change of the whole substance... This change is called transubstantiation.”*

Layman’s Example:

It’s like when a caterpillar becomes a butterfly. The outside might look similar, but the inside has completely changed. That’s what happens at Mass: the bread and wine become Jesus, even though they still look like bread and wine.

Joke:

If Jesus had meant it as a symbol, He wouldn’t have let people walk away in John 6 when He said, “Unless you eat my flesh... you have no life in you.”

No one would leave over a symbol! I mean, who gets offended by a metaphor?

3. Feeding the Hungry – The Miracle of the Loaves (Luke 9:11–17)

“They all ate and were satisfied. And the fragments left over were picked up—twelve baskets full.”

Let’s break this down in three words: Generosity, Multiplication, and Satisfaction.

Jesus sees a crowd—tired, hungry, and far from home. The disciples want to send them away, but Jesus says, *“You give them something to eat.”*

What little they had—five loaves and two fish—Jesus used to feed 5,000 men, not counting women and children.

Lesson: Jesus doesn’t ask you to have much. He just asks you to bring what you have.

Church Teaching (CCC 1329): *“The Eucharist is also called the Breaking of Bread, because this was how Jesus signified that all who eat of it are one body.”*

Real-Life Parallel:

Have you ever hosted a big family meal and worried there wouldn't be enough food? But somehow, with God's help, the pot stretches. This is what happens in the Mass: everyone is fed, not by rice or stew, but by Christ Himself.

Proverb: *"The hand that gives is the hand that receives."*

When we come to Mass, God gives us His very self—so we too must give ourselves to others.

4. What the Eucharist Demands from Us

The Eucharist is not just a gift; it's also a call to action.

"We proclaim the death of the Lord until He comes." (1 Cor 11:26)

That means:

- You can't receive the Body of Christ and still go gossip about His body—the Church.
- You can't eat from the table of heaven and refuse to help the hungry on earth.
- You can't be in communion with Jesus if you're out of communion with your neighbor.

Church Teaching (CCC 1397): *"The Eucharist commits us to the poor. To receive the Body and Blood of Christ is to be united more closely to Him and to the entire Church."*

Challenge:

Let us become living Eucharists—broken for others, shared with the world, and always united in love.

Conclusion:

The Eucharist is a meal, a sacrifice, a communion, and a mission.

So, when you come to Mass:

- Don't just come for the bread, come for the Body.
- Don't just show up with your mouth open, come with your heart open.
- Don't just sit through the Mass—become the Mass.

Proverb: *“The food that fills the stomach must also nourish the heart.”*

Let the Eucharist fill not just your belly, but your life.

Final Prayer:

Lord Jesus,

You gave Yourself fully in the Eucharist—body, blood, soul, and divinity.

May we never take for granted this heavenly food.

Fill us with Your love, teach us to give like You,

And help us to be Your presence in a hungry world.

Make us living tabernacles,

So that everywhere we go, Your light shines.

We ask this through Christ our Lord.

Amen.

CORPUS CHRISTI REFLECTION FOR KIRIWINA ISLAND

“JESUS IS THE BREAD THAT NEVER GETS SPOILED”

Readings:

Genesis 14:18–20

Psalms 109(110):1–4

1 Corinthians 11:23–26

Luke 9:11–17

Introduction:

Brothers and sisters in Christ, today we celebrate a great feast of our Catholic faith—the Solemnity of the Most Holy Body and Blood of Christ, what we call Corpus Christi.

Here in Kiriwina, we know the value of a shared meal. Whether it's a feast after a church celebration, a funeral gathering, or just everyday sharing of yam, fish, or taro—food brings people together.

But today, we are not talking about ordinary food. We are talking about the Heavenly Food—Jesus Himself in the Holy Eucharist.

1. Melchizedek and Jesus – Our Eternal Priest

“Melchizedek, king of Salem, brought out bread and wine; he was priest of God Most High.” (Genesis 14:18)

Long before Jesus was born, Melchizedek offered bread and wine in thanksgiving. This was a sign pointing to Jesus, who also offered bread and wine—but this time as His Body and Blood.

Here in Kiriwina, when someone brings food to share, it is a sign of peace and respect. Melchizedek, as priest and king, brings peace through this sacred offering. So does Jesus—He is both our High Priest and King of Peace.

Church Teaching (CCC 1544): *“The priesthood of Melchizedek prefigures the priesthood of Christ.”*

Cultural Link: When people in Kiriwina present yams to the chief, it’s more than food—it’s honor and connection. The Eucharist is like that—Jesus offers Himself to honor the Father and connect us to heaven.

2. Jesus Gave Us Himself – Not Just a Symbol (1 Corinthians 11:23–26)

“This is my body... this is my blood. Do this in memory of me.”

Jesus didn’t say, “This is LIKE my body.” He said, “This IS my body.” This is why we kneel during the Consecration. This is why we say “Amen” when we receive Communion—because we believe it is truly Jesus.

Church Teaching (CCC 1376): *“By the consecration... the bread and wine become the Body and Blood of Christ. This is called transubstantiation.”*

Real-life Understanding:

In Kiriwina, when someone cooks for you, especially a mother or grandmother, it’s not just food—it’s love on a plate. Likewise, the Eucharist is not just spiritual nutrition—it is Jesus giving His very self.

Saint Augustine said: *“Believe what you see, see what you believe, and become what you receive.”*

So, when we receive Communion, we’re not just participating in a church ceremony—we are receiving Heaven into our bodies.

Joke for the Heart:

You can miss your rice or banana for a day, but don’t miss Jesus in the Eucharist, or you’ll be spiritually hungry—even if your stomach is full!

3. Jesus Feeds the Multitude – And Still Feeds Us (Luke 9:11–17)

“They all ate and were satisfied... twelve baskets were left over.”

Let’s imagine this in Kiriwina: It’s like a big feast day in the village and people are coming from all stations—Luya, Bawai, Gusaweta, Kuluwa, Liluta, Kaulago—no one wants to go back hungry. The disciples panic, but Jesus says, “You feed them.”

They give what little they have—five loaves and two fish—and Jesus multiplies it.

Jesus still does this today in the Mass. The Eucharist might look small, but it’s enough to satisfy the entire world because it is God Himself.

Church Teaching (CCC 1329): *“The Eucharist is the Breaking of Bread—through it, all who eat of it become one body in Christ.”*

Kiriwina Image: Just as the ocean is made up of many drops of water, we, the Church, become one in Christ when we share the Eucharist.

Cultural Proverb: *“One yam cannot feed the village, but one heart shared by all can.”*

The Eucharist is the heart of Christ shared by all His people.

4. How Kiriwina Sees and Receives the Eucharist

We must be honest—some receive the Eucharist with faith, while others still struggle to understand it.

Some common issues we see:

- Some come to Mass but don’t go for Confession, yet they receive Communion.
- Some miss Mass but come only for Holy Communion during weddings or funerals.
- Some do not teach their children what Communion really means.

Church Teaching (CCC 1385): *“Anyone conscious of grave sin must receive the sacrament of Reconciliation before coming to Communion.”*

Our ancestors in Kiriwina respect sacred things—like the chief’s stool or family land. The Eucharist is even more sacred—it is God Himself!

Practical Tip:

Tell your children, “The Eucharist is not just bread—it is Jesus who loves you, feeds you, and wants to live in you.”

5. Living the Eucharist – Beyond the Church Building

“Do this in memory of me.”

This is not just about repeating the Mass—it’s about living like Christ:

- Be broken in service for others.
- Be poured out in love and forgiveness.
- Be a source of unity, not division.

When we walk out of church after Mass, we carry Christ in us. So don’t leave Jesus behind—take Him to your homes, gardens, markets, schools, and the beach.

Proverb: *“A canoe full of food feeds only if it lands at the village.”*

Let the food of the Eucharist land in your heart—so it can feed your life.

Final Encouragement

If you are not yet receiving Communion worthily:

- Go to Confession.
- Reconcile with others.
- Renew your commitment.

Don't be like the lamp that has oil but no fire—come to Mass with faith, love, and reverence.

Every time we receive Jesus in Communion, it's as if heaven has touched the sands of Kiriwina.

Closing Prayer:

Lord Jesus,

You are the Living Bread that came down from heaven.

Thank You for making Yourself small enough to be received in our hands,
and great enough to feed our souls.

May the people of Kiriwina Island love You in the Eucharist,
receive You with reverence, and live You in our daily lives.

Let our villages be holy tabernacles where You dwell,
and let our families be united like one basket of yams—together in love.

We ask this through Christ our Lord.

Amen.